

Phantasmagorical simulation theory of Metaversal Literature

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The advent of digital hypertext, internet and metaverses has made the 21st century e-lit readers swinging in the midst of four worlds of interactive apprehension. The four worlds are viz: the real world where human and hardware interact physically with each other in the software interface using synthesisers such as mouse, keyboard, screen, VR controllers; the fictional world, a spatiotemporal imaginary realm created by inner trajectories of thoughts and visuals as a result of appreciating work of arts like poetry and novel ; the virtual world or digital world which is birthed by digitality leveraging computer networks[1]; and lastly, the extended reality world where both the readers and the text are datafied as virtual embodiments engaging each other[2]. This concept establishes the metaverse as a mixture of real world; virtual reality world, augmented reality world and artificial intelligence developed via technologies [1][3]. In this context, the materiality of the text and its readers are totally integrated. This phenomenon of blurring the multimodalities defines phantasmagorical art. Thus, explains the imagination of the technological singularity for both human being and text on the cyberspace. Singularity is the major creative characteristic of the metaversal literature, and its literary utopia which projects how-the-world-should-be of the four worlds, it represents. Metaversal literature is equally characterised as hapticoverbivocovisual i.e., the contents of the literature are composite of haptics, words, audio and videos.

Metaversal literature is an immersive ludokinetic oeuvre experienced via digital self-imposed hallucination on the generated extended reality (XR) environment using animated avatars with the help of computer rendering technologies. Abramson conceived the idea of metaversal literature in 2015 to mean that it is a collaborative space of fusing binary opposites such as truth and falsehood, sincerity and irony etc. Its storyworld encompasses a fusion of original, borrowed, and reconfigured content, alongside genuine, hired, and reimagined perspectives. This storyworld aims to create heartfelt, self-revealing literary works that serve both as a means of personal introspection and as a significant expression of political engagement. [4]. On the other hand, what concerns Song, it is the fact that metaversal literature is a user generated content community of creators, users themselves and work-world on the metaverse whereby authors immediately experiences all literary roles and situations with the technology sharing avatar to truly attain empathy between themes in order to accept the mission of preventing technology risks and defending the goodness of human nature [5]. Unfortunately for Song, she based her finding on the traditional theories of

literature not electronic literature. The characteristics of virtual reality, she stated such as immersion, interactivity and imagination are the same characteristics of electronic literature which metaversal literature is its subset.

Dreyfus called such phantasmagorical art an animated hallucination i.e. accurate embodied synaesthesia or an exciting revelation of natural wonders suddenly appearing to the observer because of some clarification in his or her attention or some shift in the atmosphere or angle of vision by cameras, cinema and other mechanical illusion [6]. The concept of Dreyfus' perception of phantasmagoria in 18th century is similar to the Gesamtkunstwerk which Ayiter sees it as Romantic period concept referring to synesthetic union of all arts-from music, dance, and poetry, to visual arts and stagecraft. Ayiter continues to invoke David Morgan's four basic aspects of a Gesamtkunstwerk such as variety of media, unity of effect, physical environment and viewers' participation [7]. These Morgan's basic aspect of Gesamtkunstwerk identifies the characteristic of the metaversal literary storyworld whereby the metaversal reader (i.e. Mreader henceforth) participates in synesthetic embodiment in the storyline by controlling the narratives to suit his desire, acting as structurer of the arch of the stories.

Inversely, it is evident that people owning the metaverses could use the algorithmic influences to control, map the geographical narrative and the thought patterns of the users to achieve their socio-political ideologies via metaversal literature just like the traditional writers who have been shaping our cultures from times immemorial turning their utopia into reality as a means to subtly force the society into their desired ends. Moreover, humanity is the only constant element in all stories even with the interception of digitality, internet and metaverse that rendered natural human posthuman.

The posthuman being is fully manifested in reading metaversal literature. The literary Mreader extends from his natural tripartite to quadripartite whenever he launches himself into the metaverses to read. His avatar connects with his soul, spirit and body to make him a complete quadripartite posthuman. To this effect, his body connects with the real world, his soul links to the fictional world, his spirit imbeds in the virtual world whilst his avatar projects into the augmented world simultaneously when he performs Mreading. Therefore, Mreading erases space and time by imposing on the Mreader such a cosmological projection via the three-dimensional virtual reality headsets, glasses and haptic controllers. These invoke conscious oneiric world experience. One regains oneself when the XR glasses and headset are removed or disconnect from the metaverse.

In this regard, human loses its post-humanity when it stops interacting with metaversal literature. It is evident that metaverses are birthed from astral soul projection experience via rendering technologies. It is the reason avatars know one another, interact with each other and

meet with each other as humans which they represent on the physical world. These phenomena materialise the collusion of the Plato's world of forms with the physical world via metaverses

Therefore, the metaversal literature is the evolving future text that rooted in modelling the four worlds as mentioned above alongside the creator's utopia, and the participation of the posthuman on the informatic generated ecosystem. Metaversal literature shifts a bit from the general 2D electronic literatures on the dynamics Web 1.0 and Web 2.0 for it is built on the Web 3.0 making its stories felt, touched and sighted altogether via virtual reality synthesisers. Thus, phantasmagorical simulation theory of metaversal literature is explored in the metaversal literature definition and its storyworld.

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